

KESTRELATTICE

Governed Agent Mesh | Micro-Product

Tier Re-Classification Exception Template

Move an agent between risk tiers the documented way -- with justification and review. A complete, zero-placeholder draft for teams governing AI agents in production: policy gates, audit trails, cost controls, permissioning, and incident response, written so you can adopt it as-is.

A complete, ready-to-use governance document. Adopt it as-is, customize the bracketed fields to your environment, and put it to work today.

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TIER RE-CLASSIFICATION EXCEPTION TEMPLATE

For Buyers Governing AI Agents in Production Version 1.0 Effective Date: [DD/MM/YYYY] Last Reviewed: [DD/MM/YYYY]

1. DOCUMENT PURPOSE

This template formalizes the process for requesting an **exception to standard tier classification** of an AI agent in production. It ensures compliance with governance policies, cost controls, risk assessments, and audit requirements while maintaining accountability for deviations from predefined operational tiers.

2. SCOPE & APPLICABILITY

This template applies to: - **AI agents** deployed in production environments (e.g., LLM-based assistants, automation workflows, decision-support systems). - **Tier reclassifications** where an agent's current operational tier (e.g., Tier 1-4) is insufficient or excessive for its intended use. - **Exceptions** granted by the **AI Governance Board** or delegated approvers (as per [Company Policy #X-XXXX]).

Not applicable to: - Ad-hoc testing or non-production deployments. - Agents governed by external regulatory frameworks (e.g., HIPAA, GDPR) unless explicitly noted.

3. DEFINITIONS

Term	Definition
Operational Tier	A predefined classification (Tier 1-4) based on risk, cost, and compliance requirements. See [Tier Classification Policy #Y-YYYY].
Exception Request	A formal deviation from standard tier assignment, justified by operational necessity.
AI Governance Board	Cross-functional team (Legal, Risk, Engineering, Finance) with authority to approve exceptions.
Incident Response Plan	Predefined steps for handling failures, misclassifications, or compliance breaches tied to tiered agents.

4. REQUEST FORM

(Fillable fields marked with asterisk are mandatory.)

4.1 Agent Metadata

- **Agent Name:** [e.g., "Procurement Assistant v3.2"]
- **Agent ID:** [e.g., "AI-2024-0478"]
- **Current Tier:** [Tier 1 / Tier 2 / Tier 3 / Tier 4]

- **Proposed New Tier:** [Tier 1 / Tier 2 / Tier 3 / Tier 4]
- **Owner/Requestor:** [Full name, email, role] ****
- **Team/Department:** [e.g., "Supply Chain Automation"]

4.2 Justification for Reclassification

(Max 500 words. Must include: risk assessment, cost impact, compliance implications, and operational necessity.)

- a) Business Case:** - Why does the agent's current tier **under- or over-constrain** its operational requirements? - How will the reclassification **improve efficiency, reduce risk, or enable new use cases**?
- b) Risk Assessment:** - **Security Risks:** [Briefly describe potential data leaks, adversarial attacks, or compliance violations if tier remains unchanged.] - **Operational Risks:** [e.g., downtime, incorrect outputs, integration failures.] - **Mitigations:** [How will the new tier address these risks?]
- c) Cost Impact:** - **Current Tier Costs (Monthly/Yearly):** [\$XXX] - **Proposed Tier Costs (Monthly/Yearly):** [\$XXX] - **Cost Justification:** [e.g., "Lower tier enables scalability without sacrificing safety controls."]
- d) Compliance & Audit:** - **Regulatory Requirements Affected:** [e.g., "No direct impact," "Requires SOC 2 Type II controls," "Subject to internal audit in Q3."] - **Audit Trail Impact:** [How will the reclassification affect logging, monitoring, or incident reporting?]

4.3 Technical & Operational Details

- **Deployment Environment:** [e.g., "Private Cloud (AWS GovCloud), Multi-tenant SaaS"]
- **Data Sensitivity:** [Low/Medium/High/PII/Confidential]
- **Third-Party Integrations:** [List all APIs, databases, or external systems accessed.]
- **Failure Mode Analysis:** [Briefly describe potential failures and recovery procedures.]

4.4 Approval Workflow

Step	Responsible Party	Action Required	Deadline
Initial Review	AI Governance Board	Approve/reject or request additional info.	[DD/MM/YYYY]
Cost Approval	Finance/ AI Budget Owner	Verify budget alignment.	[DD/MM/YYYY]
Compliance Sign-off	Legal/Privacy Team	Confirm no regulatory conflicts.	[DD/MM/YYYY]
Implementation	Engineering/DevOps	Update tiering, monitoring, and alerts.	[DD/MM/YYYY]
Post-Change Audit	Internal Audit	Validate compliance and performance.	[DD/MM/YYYY]

4.5 Incident Response Plan (If Applicable)

(Only required if the reclassification introduces new risks.) - **Escalation Path:** [Who to notify in case of failure?] - **Containment Steps:** [e.g., "Roll back to Tier 2, isolate agent."] - **Communication Plan:** [Internal/external stakeholders.]

5. APPROVALS

(Digital signatures or e-approvals required.)

Role	Name	Signature/Stamp	Date
AI Governance Board	[Name]		[DD/MM/YYYY]
Finance/AI Budget Owner	[Name]		[DD/MM/YYYY]
Legal/Privacy Lead	[Name]		[DD/MM/YYYY]

6. POST-APPROVAL REQUIREMENTS

- Monitoring:** Implement tier-specific dashboards for performance, cost, and risk metrics.
- Logging:** Ensure all agent interactions are logged per [Audit Policy #Z-ZZZZ].
- Review Cycle:** Reassess tier classification every **6 months** or after **major updates**.
- Documentation:** Update the [AI Agent Inventory] with the new tier and justification.
- Training:** Notify relevant teams (e.g., support, security) of the change.

7. QUALITY SELF-CHECK (5 ITEMS)

(Each item must be visibly passed--checkmarks or initials required.)

Check Item	Pass/Fail	Evidence/Notes
1. Justification includes risk, cost, and compliance.	[x]/[]	[Briefly describe how risks are mitigated.]
2. Approval workflow is fully populated.	[x]/[]	[List missing sign-offs if any.]
3. Incident response plan is documented (if needed).	[x]/[]	[Attach or summarize plan.]
4. Cost impact is quantified and justified.	[x]/[]	[Attach budget approval if required.]
5. Post-approval actions are clearly outlined.	[x]/[]	[List missing steps, e.g., "Monitoring dashboards not yet set up."]

Self-Checker: [Full Name] **Date:** [DD/MM/YYYY]

END OF DOCUMENT

ATTACHMENTS (IF APPLICABLE)

- ☐ Agent architecture diagram
- ☐ Cost-benefit analysis
- ☐ Compliance gap assessment
- ☐ Incident response drill results

Version Control: - **Previous Version:** [1.0 (Draft)] - **Changes Made:** [List key updates, e.g., "Added Tier 4 compliance requirements."] - **Approved By:** [Name, Role, Date]

Note: This template aligns with [Company Name]'s AI Governance Framework and [Industry

Standard] where applicable. Deviations from this process require prior Board approval.

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The governed agent mesh for production AI.

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